FACING NORTH
TRAVELS & TOURS

## GOLDEN TRAILS OF THE NORTH

# ADVENTURE ACROSS MOUNTAINS & MEADOWS

TRAVELING DATES

**28TH OCT → 8TH NOV**

PRODUCT CODE: AT26-02

**12 DAYS 11 NIGHTS**

# ITINERARY

## A COMPLETE GUIDE TO YOUR JOURNEY TO THE MOUNTAIN

**STYLE:** NATURE, CULTURE, HERITAGE & FOOD

**TRAVELER'S RATING:** ★★★★½

## OVERVIEW:

Journey Through the Heart of the Karakoram – A Co-Hosted Adventure

This spring, we embark to the majestic north of Pakistan for an unforgettable 10-day journey through Hunza and Skardu, co-hosted with some of the world's most inspiring travel creators. This trip isn't just about landscapes, it's about connection, culture, and community. Together, we'll wander through ancient valleys, share stories under starlit skies, and capture moments that celebrate the spirit of exploration. From the turquoise lakes of Hunza to the serene valleys of Skardu, every day promises a perfect blend of adventure, creativity, and meaningful human connection.

Experience Pakistan like never before together.

**START:** ISLAMABAD - - -

MEET YOUR CO-HOST

# MARIUS

My name is **Marius**, and I'm 28 years old.

I started photography six years ago. Back then, I focused on portraits, but I soon realized that I enjoy photographing nature and wildlife much more. Since then, I've been using every free moment to spend time outdoors and follow my passion.

This recent trip to Pakistan especially showed me just how much nature has to offer. I've never experienced landscapes as breathtaking as these before. The towering mountains, the vast valleys full of vibrant colors, and the bright blue rivers completely captivated me.

That's why I want to bring this incredible nature closer to you and share a journey like this together.

I'm looking forward to meeting you!

Marius

# IS THIS TRIP RIGHT FOR YOU?

Please note that a more conservative dress code applies for some of the sightseeing on the city tour. Entrance may be denied at some sights if this is not followed.

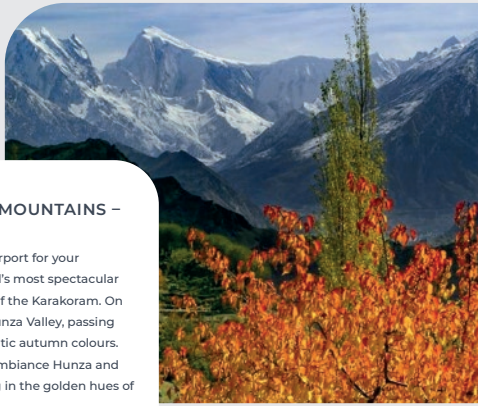
It is recommended that you wear warm clothes, long sleeves and long trousers/skirt/jeans.

The Jeep Safari on this itinerary involves off-road driving through rugged areas - which all adds to the excitement. However, because of the adventurous nature of the journey and the rough terrain covered, we do not recommend this activity to passengers if they have any pre-existing medical conditions, are over 70 or pregnant.

## 28TH OCT/ DAY 1: ARRIVAL AT ISLAMABAD

Khushamdeed, Welcome to the capital of Pakistan. Upon arrival, once you clear the customs and collect your luggage, you will be met and greeted by Facing North on Location representatives and will be transferred to your hotel. The drive to your hotel will be approximately 30 minutes. Time to settle in and relax after your international flight. You may wish to take a quick half day city tour. Dinner will be served at the renowned The Lost Tribe with a stunning panoramic view of Islamabad and Rawalpindi. Situated on the roof top hill, your dinner experience tonight at The Lost Tribe will be a great introduction to Pakistani cuisine.A brief introduction will also be given to give you pointers of the upcoming tour.

**Activities:** Quick Tour Islamabad



## 29TH OCT/ DAY 2: INTO THE MOUNTAINS – SKIES, PEAKS & VALLEYS

After an early breakfast, transfer to the airport for your Islamabad → Gilgit flight, one of the world's most spectacular aerial journeys offering sweeping views of the Karakoram. On arrival, begin your scenic drive toward Hunza Valley, passing terraced fields, cliffside roads, and dramatic autumn colours. Upon reaching Karimabad, check in at Ambiance Hunza and enjoy the rest of the day at leisure, taking in the golden hues of fall across the valley.

## 30TH OCT/ DAY 3: HERITAGE, FORTS & EMPOWERMENT IN HUNZA

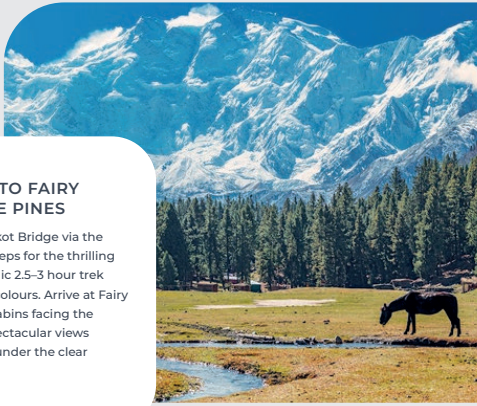
The day is dedicated to exploring the cultural heart of Hunza. We begin with a scenic heritage walk through the charming Karimabad Bazaar, gradually ascending towards the majestic Baltit Fort, a centuries-old symbol of Hunza's history and royal legacy. After a guided tour of the fort, we return to the bazaar before heading to the nearby Altit Fort, a beautifully restored monument surrounded by the ancient Altit Royal Gardens. A highlight of the visit is a stop at Khabasi Café, a hidden gem within the fort premises run entirely by local women, a remarkable initiative by Prince Aga Khan promoting female empowerment in the region. The day winds down with a relaxing evening stroll, a bit of souvenir shopping in Karimabad, and a peaceful return to the hotel to rest and recharge for the adventures ahead.

## 31ST OCT/ DAY 4: ATTABAD LAKE, HUSSAINI BRIDGE, PASSU GLACIER WALK & BORITH LAKE

After a hearty breakfast, the day begins with a scenic journey towards Attabad Lake, one of Pakistan's most breathtaking turquoise wonders. We continue towards the thrilling Hussaini Suspension Bridge, known for its daring planks and stunning backdrop reached via a short downhill walk. After some time for photos and exploration, we head to the peaceful Borith Lake for freshly prepared local snacks enjoyed by the water. From there, a short drive takes us to Zero Point, the starting point for our Passu Glacier Hike, a rewarding 40-minute trek offering panoramic views of the Passu Cones and the majestic glacier. We return to Attabad Lake and check into a lakeside resort where the rest of the evening is all about leisure and lakeside adventure. Jet skiing and boating await in the serene setting, followed by a peaceful dinner by the lake. Overnight stay at the resort.

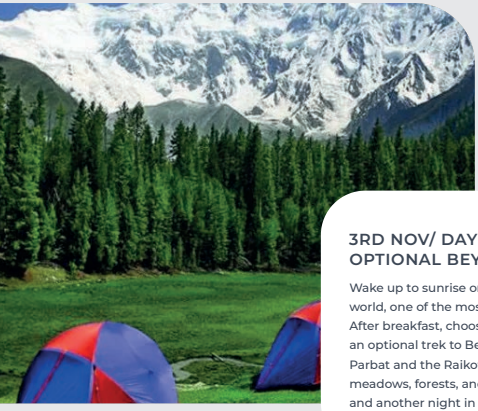
## 1ST NOV/ DAY 5: MOUNTAIN MAJESTY & VILLAGE CHARM

We begin the day with an early breakfast before departing for Gilgit, passing through lush valleys and winding roads. A highlight stop awaits in Minapin, one of the oldest and most picturesque villages of the Nagar Valley. Surrounded by orchards, visitors can enjoy a peaceful garden walk and, depending on the season, taste fresh local fruits or take in the colorful blossoms. From here, a jeep adventure takes us to the breathtaking Miacher KOH viewpoint offering sweeping panoramic views of the Rakaposhi Range and the dramatic ice ridge connecting Rakaposhi to Diran Peak. This is a dream spot for photography and drone footage. After returning to Minapin, we indulge in an authentic local dining experience at Osho Thang, known for its traditional flavors. The day ends with a scenic drive to Gilgit for an overnight stay



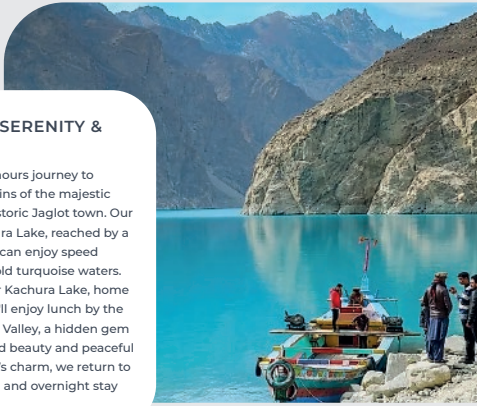
## 2ND NOV/ DAY 6: JOURNEY TO FAIRY MEADOWS & TREK INTO THE PINES

After breakfast, depart Gilgit toward Raikot Bridge via the Karakoram Highway. Transfer into 4x4 jeeps for the thrilling ascent to Tato Village, followed by a scenic 2.5–3 hour trek through forests glowing with warm fall colours. Arrive at Fairy Meadows and settle into your wooden cabins facing the mighty Nanga Parbat. Enjoy tea with spectacular views before a cozy dinner around a fireplace under the clear Himalayan sky.



## 3RD NOV/ DAY 7: FAIRY MEADOWS & OPTIONAL BEYAL CAMP TREK

Wake up to sunrise on the ninth highest mountain in the world, one of the most majestic morning views anywhere. After breakfast, choose to relax at the meadows or embark on an optional trek to Beyal Camp, offering closer views of Nanga Parbat and the Raikot Glacier. Enjoy a peaceful afternoon amid meadows, forests, and golden autumn scenery before dinner and another night in the mountains.

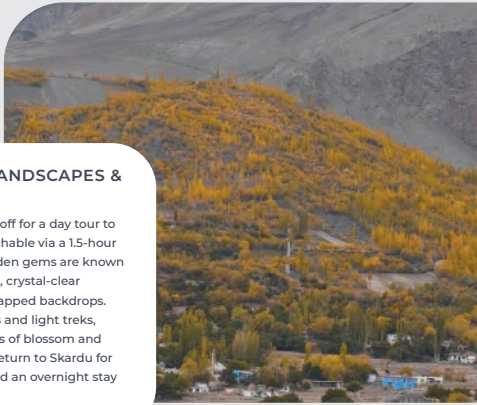


## 4TH NOV/ DAY 8: LAKESIDE SERENITY & HIDDEN VALLEYS

After breakfast, we set off on a scenic 4 hours journey to Skardu, venturing deep into the mountains of the majestic Baltistan region, passing through the historic Jaglot town. Our first stop is the enchanting Upper Kachura Lake, reached by a short 15-minute trek. Here, thrill-seekers can enjoy speed boating or take a daring dip in the ice-cold turquoise waters. We then head down to the serene Lower Kachura Lake, home to the iconic Shangrila Resort, where we'll enjoy lunch by the lake. In the afternoon, we venture to Soq Valley, a hidden gem just 45 minutes away, offering untouched beauty and peaceful surroundings. After soaking in the valley's charm, we return to the resort in Shigar for a relaxed evening and overnight stay

## 5TH NOV/ DAY 9: MOUNTAIN HEIGHTS & DESERT CALM

Today begins with an early breakfast before embarking on a day journey to Khaplu valley, crossing Guwari trees and sailing valley where the pristine water streams will take your breath away. Stopover at Kaiser suspension bridge. Continue to drive to Khaplu. Visit Khaplu palace. Lunch will be at Khaplu Palace. Leisure and return back to Skardu. The adventure continues with a horse ride through the mystical Sarfaranga Cold Desert, we'll enjoy a peaceful sunset over the desert horizon before returning to the resort for a restful overnight stay.

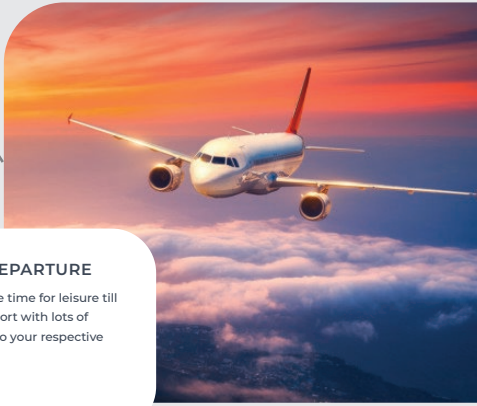


## 6TH NOV/ DAY 10: SPRING LANDSCAPES & MOUNTAIN VALLEYS

After an early morning breakfast, we set off for a day tour to either Basho or Chunda Valley, both reachable via a 1.5-hour off-road journey from Skardu. These hidden gems are known for their breathtaking Spring landscapes, crystal-clear mountain streams, and majestic snow-capped backdrops. We'll spend the day enjoying short walks and light treks, immersing ourselves in the vibrant colors of blossom and pristine natural beauty. By evening, we return to Skardu for some leisure time, followed by dinner and an overnight stay at the resort.

## 7TH NOV/ DAY 11: SKARDU TO ISLAMABAD

Breakfast will be served at the hotel. Transfer to Airport, depart to Islamabad via flight. An hour air safari, flying over the mighty Karakorum and Kaghan region. Arrival at Islamabad airport, transfer to hotel.Leisure and stroll in the shopping centres. Farewell dinner at a hand picked restaurant. Return to the hotel, Overnight stay.



## 8TH NOV/ DAY 12: DAY OF DEPARTURE

Breakfast will be served at the hotel. Free time for leisure till your flight departure. transfer to the airport with lots of memories to cherish forever. departure to your respective country.

Activities: Departure to your country

# INCLUSIONS

| SERVICES | PREMIUM PACKAGE |
|---|---|
| Meals | Daily 3 Meals |
| Transportation | Toyota Coaster New Shape & Prado (2007) |
| ISB→ GLT & KDU→ISB Return Flight | YES |
| 2 Nights Islamabad | Ambiance Resort (Premier Rooms) |
| 2 Nights Central Hunza | Ambiance Resort (Premier Rooms) |
| 1 Night Upper Hunza | Zen By The Lake (Deluxe Rooms) |
| 1 Night Gilgit | Ramada Hotel (Deluxe Rooms) |
| 2 Nights Fairy Meadows | Raikot Sarai (Standard Hut) |
| 3 Nights Skardu | GreenPak Resort (Deluxe Rooms) |
| Souvenirs | Yes |
| Arrival & Farewell Dinner | Yes |
| Bonfire Night with BBQ Dinner | Yes |
| English Speaking Guide | Yes |
| Driver, Guide, Toll, Parking Expense | Yes |
| Entry to all forts, Museum & Boating | Yes |

## PACKAGE COST

| PER PERSON COST | PREMIUM PACKAGE |
|---|---|
| **Package cost per person** | **$2,400** |

**All Above prices are quoted for double occupancy**

**Note:** Single supplement will be charged extra USD.650

**Note:** We will try our level best to distribute rooms on double occupancy according to the gender

# HOTEL BOOKINGS

**-CENTRAL HUNZA**

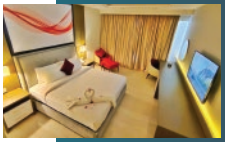
AMBIANCE HOTEL

**-UPPER HUNZA**

ZEN BY THE LAKE

**-GILGIT**

RAMADA HOTEL



**-SKARDU**

GREENPAK RESORTS

**FAIRY MEADOWS**

RAIKOT SARAI (STANDARD HUT)

**-ISLAMABAD**

AMBIANCE HOTEL

## WHAT IS INCLUDED?

– Documentation for Visa Application
– Round Trip domestic flight (Islamabad – Skardu)
– Airport meet and greet
– All transfers
– All accommodation as indicated on the itinerary
– Entrance fees to national parks and monuments
– English speaking guide and Resident Director
– Local bottled water daily

## WHAT IS NOT INCLUDED?

– Visa Application Fees
– International Flights
– Gratitutes
– Personal Expenses
– Travel Insurance
– Anything not mentioned above in the itinerary and inclusions

## RIGHTS OF ADMISSIONS RESERVED

- Incase of any unforeseen event, additional expenses might apply.

- Travel insurance is must for all the guests traveling to Northern areas.

- Incase of bad weather or flight cancellations or road blockages alternative measures might have to be taken, charges may apply.

- Anything not mentioned above in the Itinerary is not included.

- Incase of extra Luggage (more than 20 kgs) charges may apply on the domestic flights.

## ESSENTIALS TO PACK:

Spring in the mountains brings mild days and cool evenings pack light but smart

– **Clothing:** Layered outfits, warm jacket, rain shell, comfy walking shoes.
– **Accessories:** Sunglasses, hat, reusable water bottle, power bank, travel adapter.
– **Gear:** Camera/drone, extra batteries, and memory cards.
– **Personal Care:** Sunscreen, lip balm, basic first aid, personal medicines.
– **Documents:** Passport, visa, travel insurance, and photocopies.
– **Extras:** Small backpack, snacks, and a good spirit for adventure!

## ESSENTIAL TRIP INFO:

Warm Clothes will be required in the northern region of Pakistan, rest the weather will be moderate.

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